D Lent 7 Grammar notes

REVISION: The future tense

- The future tense is used to describe:
  - **What you will be doing** *(I will be eating)*
  - **What you will do** *(I will eat)*

- To form the future tense, simply:
  - Take the infinitive (removing the final E of –RE verbs) manger, finir, vendre
  - Add the correct personal ending: (rather like "AVOIR" in the present tense)

je	PARLER – **ai**
tu	FINIR – **as**
il/elle	VENDR – **a**
nous	RÉUSSIR – **ons**
vous	RENCONTRER – **ez**
ils	RENDR – **ont**

- As usual, there are some frequently used **irregular stems** to learn:

avoir	**j'aur ai**	*vouloir*	**je voudr ai**
aller	**j'ir ai**	*mourir*	**je mourr ai**
être	**je ser ai**	*pouvoir*	**je pourr ai**
voir	**je verr ai**	*courir*	**je courr ai**
envoyer	**j'enverr ai**	*savoir*	**je saur ai**
recevoir	**je recevr ai**	*s'asseoir*	**je m'assiér ai**
devoir	**je devr ai**	*il faut*	**il faudr a**
faire	**je fer ai**	*il pleut*	**il pleuvr a**
venir	**je viendr ai**		
tenir	**je tiendr ai**		

Some spelling changes in the future tense

- In F Mich 3, you learned some important spelling changes that affect all persons except "nous/vous" in the present tense. **(-YER verbs, -E/É-consonant-ER verbs and APPELER, RAPPELER, JETER).** Look back.

- In the future tense, these same changes happen in the same verbs, but IN ALL PERSONS.
  - *j'essaierai, nous essaierons j'appellerai, nous appellerons*

The “hidden future”: after words like “when”

- French uses the future tense on one occasion when English does not. **The future is needed after the word “when”** and other temporal conjuctions which practically mean the same thing, such as “*as soon as*” **if the action referred to is a future event**. If the event is not a future event, then the usual tense is used.

  - *J’irai à l’université quand J’AURAI 18 ans.* **(quand + future event)**
  - *Je me couche quand je suis fatigué* **(quand + non-future event)**
  - *Je me coucherai quand je SERAI fatigué* **(quand + future event)**
  - *Dès que je recevrai la lettre, je la lirai* **(dès que + future event)**
  - *Aussitôt que je suis rentré, je me suis couché* **(aussitôt que + non-future event)**

Linking one verb to another

- Very frequently you will need to link verbs together. The first verb will be conjugated and the second (and any other) verb(s) will be in the infinitive linked either by “à”, “de” or no preposition. **Revise these common ones.**

no preposition	link with à	link with de
adorer	*apprendre à*	*arrêter/cesser de*
aimer (mieux)	*commencer à*	*décider de*
compter	*continuer à*	*se dépêcher de*
désirer	*consentir à*	*essayer de*
détester	*hésiter à*	*finir de*
espérer	*se mettre à*	*oublier de*
il faut	*passer son temps à*	*refuser de*
penser	*réussir à*	*avoir besoin de*
préférer		
devoir		
vouloir		
pouvoir		

- **After verbs of motion** (coming and going) you must not be tempted to add the word "ET" before the infinitive like the English equivalent:

  - *Viens ~~et~~ me voir demain! Allez ~~et~~ le chercher dans le salon!*

- **FAILLIR**: this verb is followed directly by an infinitive and means "to nearly". It can only be used in the perfect tense to refer to something unpleasant which "nearly" happened:

  - *J'ai failli me perdre; nous avons failli être renversés par un vélo.*